As an indication of the passage of time, one of the young women I met there happened to be one of those I corresponded with in the prewar days. I was married, of course, but she had gone me one better. She had been married and divorced.

I then had dinner with the de Camps, whom I hadn't seen in over a year.

Then Ed James of Operation Crossroads, who had just gotten out of the Army, came to New York on October 29, and we got a special-delivery letter informing us of the fact on that very day. Dinner was about to be started, but we put everything back in cupboards and refrigerators and dashed out. We had a fancy dinner for four (Ed's wife was along with him).

After Ed returned from Crossroads, he and his wife stayed in Petersburg at Gladys Credo's old rooms and apparently the landlady told them lurid tales about Gladys and me.

I was horrified and said, "But I was never alone indoors with her, Ed. Either I saw her in the company of others, or I met her in the street and talked to her there."

Oh well. As Hamlet said, "Be thou as chaste as ice, as pure as snow, thou shalt not escape calumny."

And speaking of calumny, the rumors went around Crossroads that I had been taken off the project for any of a variety of reasons discreditable to myself.

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Things disappear as well as reappear.

In Philadelphia, Gertrude had made a bust of me in clay. It was nearly life-size and it was an excellent likeness. People who visited us, knowing nothing about the bust, would see it and know at once it was of me.

I was very fond of it myself. After all, it both looked like me and was handsome, and that's a combination that's hard to beat.

But on the morning of October 7, 1946, Gertrude and I, while scuffling playfully, managed to knock it off the bookcase and it smashed into a hundred pieces. I still miss that bust.

Then, on October 10, Gertrude played with some mercury I had brought home